



DIY: Recording without a mic

Need to record speaker sound? Need to identify a song without microphone? Know how it happens here: <http://digit.in/virtuallaudcble>

Q&A

few minutes, there might still be a bleak ray of hope for you. Once the components are dried completely, put them back inside in one-by-one. Use the trusty old trial and elimination method of installing and checking components one-by-one to find the culprit that's causing trouble. Also, source a PSU from someone and use that in your PC instead of your own PSU to check whether the PC still shuts down. If it doesn't, then you know where the error lies. And if the PC still shuts down, then it might be a problem with your motherboard as well. Meanwhile, you can get your dried-up PSU checked from the service center and get that sorted out as well.

Noise is giving me a headache

Hello Digit. I'm someone who likes to work in a really quiet environment because that's when I'm the most productive. Which is why I was wondering whether there's any way in which I can make my PC run quieter. Lately, I've been hearing some whirring sounds from the case and previously when there were no whirring sounds, the default



Dust clogs up on the fans and makes them noisy

sound coming from the case was still on the higher side according to me. Please suggest me ways to make it run quieter so that I can work in proper silence. Thanks.

—Aditya Prajapati

A From what you've described, it's certain that your PCs case fans are to blame for the noise. It's understandable because case fans are the primary cause of noise coming from most computers. Also, CPU heatsink fans run fast or slow depending on the heat that the CPU is generating under load which is why you'll hear the heatsink fan spin with

an audible whir when the PC is under high stress. So, if you want to get rid of the noise, you'll need to open up your PC case and clean all the fans installed inside as dirt clogs up on the fans over time which can be one of the reasons for the whirring sound. You can use a soft piece of damp cloth coupled with ear cleaning buds or a can of compressed air to do the cleaning efficiently. Using a soft paint brush for cleaning would work as well. But since you said that your fans have always made a lot of noise, it'll be better if you go ahead and buy silent fans for your PC case as most of the times, the stock PC case fans are loud. Firstly, check your cabinet and weigh your options as far as the case fan size is concerned because your case may support fans of only a particular size. Head over to the cabinet's product page online or check out its user manual to know the same. Once you know which size to go for you can easily find silent case fans at e-tailers or your neighbourhood computer store. We suggest you to go for case fans made by Noctua as they have a reputation for manufacturing extremely silent fans that offer great cooling



A can of compressed air can help you clean a dusty PC

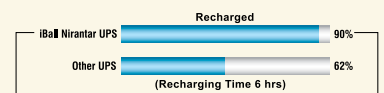
as well. For 120mm requirements, the Noctua NF-F12-PWM is a really good choice but be ready to pay a premium for it. Additionally, to make your case more silent, you should also clean the GPU fan fins, tighten all case fans with their screws because keeping them loose would make them vibrate, use rubber gaskets around the fans to decrease vibration even further. You also have a choice to go either for a silent PC case that features sound dampening materials inside or a silent CPU cooler or both. Let us know how it works out for you. **[E]**



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